

The Dispossessed

Chapter One

There was a wall. It did not look important. It was built of uncut rocks roughly mortared. An adult could look right over it, and even a child could climb it. Where it crossed the roadway, instead of having a gate it degenerated into mere geometry, a line, an idea of boundary. But the idea was real.

Chapter Two

In a square window in a white wall was the clear, bare sky. In the center of the sky was the sun. There were seven rooms opening off the corridor. Each of them had a window, and each window looked out on the same bare sky.

Chapter Three

The spaceship was a great, gaunt, black thing, standing on end. It had been built for a purpose that no longer existed, and it stood there like a monument to an idea that had outlived its usefulness.